

ELIZABETH

A Dramatic Monologue

Performer: Fiona Celestine

School: Cherish Academy

Event: Platform Division — Expressive Reading

Character: Elizabeth, mother of John the Baptist — Biblical character and setting

Scripture: Luke 1:24–25 | Luke 1:41–45 | Luke 1:57–64

Time Limit: 4 – 6 minutes

Prop: None required

INTRODUCTION

(spoken before the monologue — does not count toward time)

*My name is Fiona Celestine, representing Cherish Academy.
The monolog I will present today is titled "Elizabeth."
I will be portraying Elizabeth, wife of Zechariah
and mother of John the Baptist,
whose story is found in the Gospel of Luke, chapter one.*

THE MONOLOGUE

(Elizabeth stands quietly, as if remembering. When she speaks, it is with warmth and deep conviction.)

The words dropped out of heaven into my heart so strongly,
I had to speak them out loud.

*"This is what the Lord has done for me at the time when he has been
gracious to me,
to take away my disgrace among people."*

That's what I said when our son John was finally born.

There were many days of silence before it,
from the day my husband Zechariah emerged from the temple.

He was alive, thank God!
We thought he was dead, he was in there so long.

When he emerged he was transformed,
as though he'd seen the face of God himself!

His was a mix of fear and wonder.
His face ablaze with light
as Moses' must have been when he came down from the mountain.
The only words to describe him was as "one astonished."

But his voice was gone.
Buried and unreachable,
just like the seed planted in my womb
so that something new could be made, could grow.

It wasn't only I who conceived something,
but Zechariah did too.

God conceived in him the truth
that there is nothing worth saying
unless it is a word spoken in faith or obedience.

(pause — tender, reflective)

Just as my womb was all dammed up,
hardened and old like a stone that couldn't be broken
until the angel came and spoke —

just like that womb was touched
and turned into the place where God himself would create a redemption story for
his people,
so was Zechariah's faith forever changed.

(growing in strength)

This is what the Lord has done!

He broke off the shame that weighed on me
heavier and heavier every year.

Shame that came not from doing wrong,
but because we could not produce
what was our every right and our every hope to produce:

a child!

A little boy to carry our name.

A son to carry our hopes and our faith into the future.

(voice lifts)

But then the angel came to Zechariah in the temple
and our lives changed!

I bore a son.

The fruit of love and prayer and yes, even our faith!

(smiling, remembering)

And when Zechariah's mouth was opened
after all those quiet days,
he knew exactly what to say.

Knew it just as I knew who my child would be
as he turned inside of me,
so restless to emerge,
so restless to be his own voice
in a wilderness of unbelief
to prepare the way for the Lord.

(soft, awed)

I will never forget Zechariah's first words
when God finally loosed his tongue:

That by the tender mercy of God
we were all set free from the power of our enemy!

(warm, joyful)

That freedom is why John leapt in my womb
when my cousin Mary visited us
to tell me she, too, was pregnant.

It's why every year at this time
I remember the birth of another baby
whose miracle arrival is a story
even more wonderful and powerful than the one I've just told you today.

(stepping forward, speaking directly to the audience)

At this time of the year we can be sure of God's power
to bring about his promises.

At this time of the year we remember
that God's redemption is inside of us
and that it's for all of the world.

(quietly, with deep conviction)

And after thoughtful silence,
it's at this time of the year
that we must speak the words of his incredible stories
out loud in faith!

(lights fade)

Luke 1:24–25 | Luke 1:41–45 | Luke 1:57–64

Fiona Celestine | Cherish Academy | Accelerate Ministries Convention 2024